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DinSync RE-303: adapting the kit to the Syntaur replica case

Expert knob twiddling Follow 4 min read · May 11, 2025

On a recent development the good folks at Syntaur released a new product that serves as replacement for damaged TB-303 cases or to use for whichever projects you may need. I've always wanted to make an RE-303 clone kit with battery operation so this was a great opportunity to give it a go.

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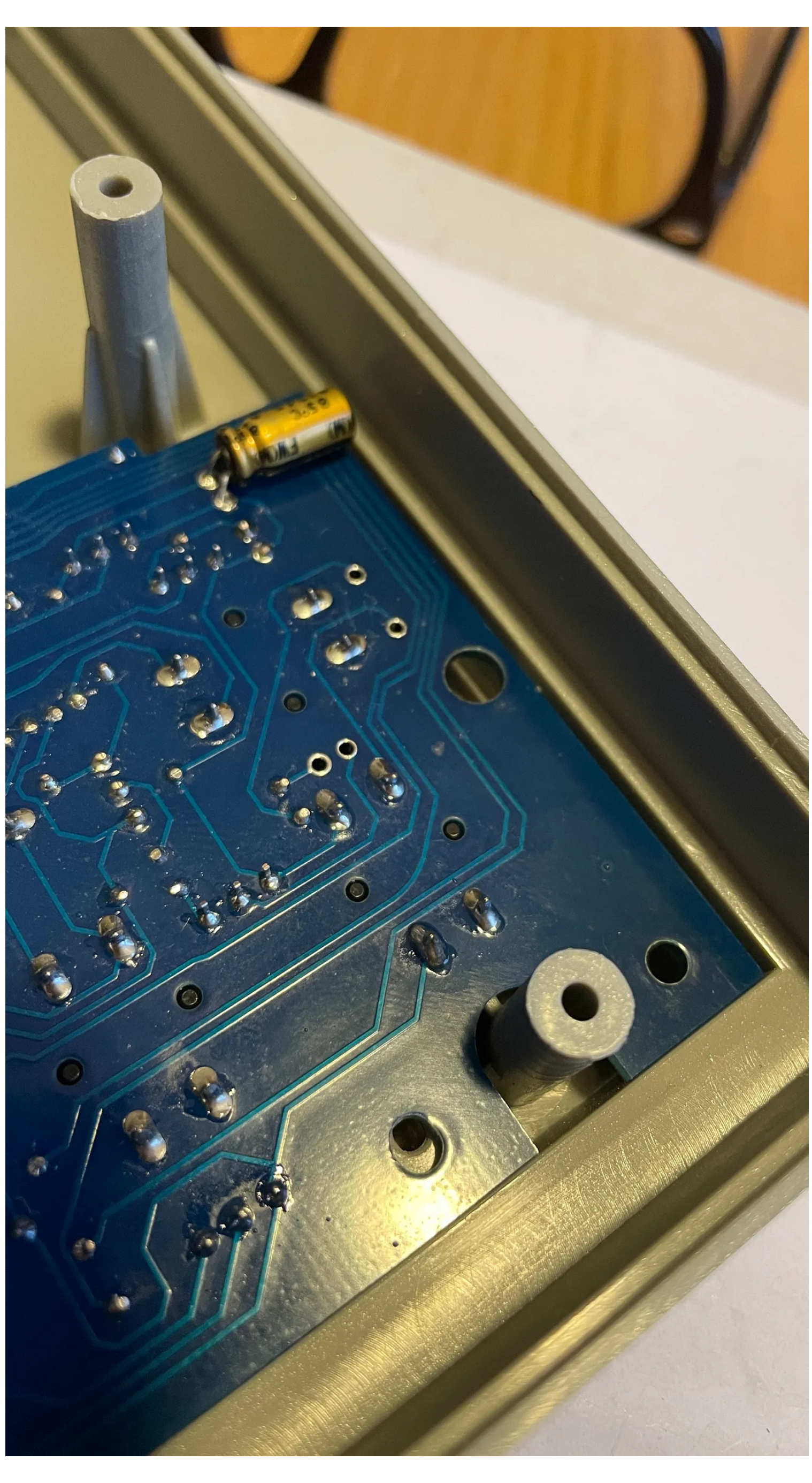
Essentially this case is the same as the TT-303 MKI case, as it's made using the same molds, but re-printed quite faithfully to be like the original. In fact a TB-303 does fit nicely without further modifications. Not so with the RE-303, which has a few differences that can prevent the operation to be exactly a perfect fit. Let's see what's needed to be made in order to make it work.

- One of the major differences is the holes attaching the battery cover to the top case while holding the switchboard against it. There's around 1mm offset here which we have to drill expanding the hole. An electric screwdriver with slow speed will work perfectly. Just go slow and steady.



- Also Notice in the image above that C201 has been installed underneath the switchboard. This is to avoid bumping into a screw post that was originally used for the TT-303 but not on RE or TB. If you find the RUN and R/S cables getting too much on the way when fitting the front panel you can also install C202 underneath. Just be cautious so that the polarity matches the picture on the top of the switchboard.
- The other major difference in the switchboard is a 1mm offset in the top 5 row of black keys. To fix this you can swap the switchboard plate for the aluminum one that DinSync sells or adapt to the one in the Syntaur case. For this last option you will have to slightly modify the tact switches (here I used Omron with light action switches). Take 5 switches, cut the 2 little plastic nubs on the bottom that lock them to the PCB holes and modify the pins by bending them like this:

After that you can solder them as low as they allow, letting you gain around 0.8mm. With the modification previously done to the battery cover screw holes you will have enough play to make a good fit. Notice the middle tact switch in this row of 3 that's been modified. Solder as flat to the PCB as you can:

The LEDs above the modified tact switches are also slightly offset so you can also slightly bend them after soldering so they look like this:

- If you're using the 3D printed Din Sync port that's provided by some builders you will have to cut around a 1mm step to the top edge so it fits the top case rim inside:

- Another trick is, if you feel like the top row of buttons sits too low than desirable on the final fit you can add a plastic washer on the top of the middle snap-in post. Don't worry about making it go all the way through the switchboard hole, it will hold it more than well enough:

With all this done you should have no issues getting all of the parts come together.

Special thanks to Carlos from RareSynthParts for help and suggestions.

DIY Re 303 Tb 303

Written by Expert knob twiddling

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